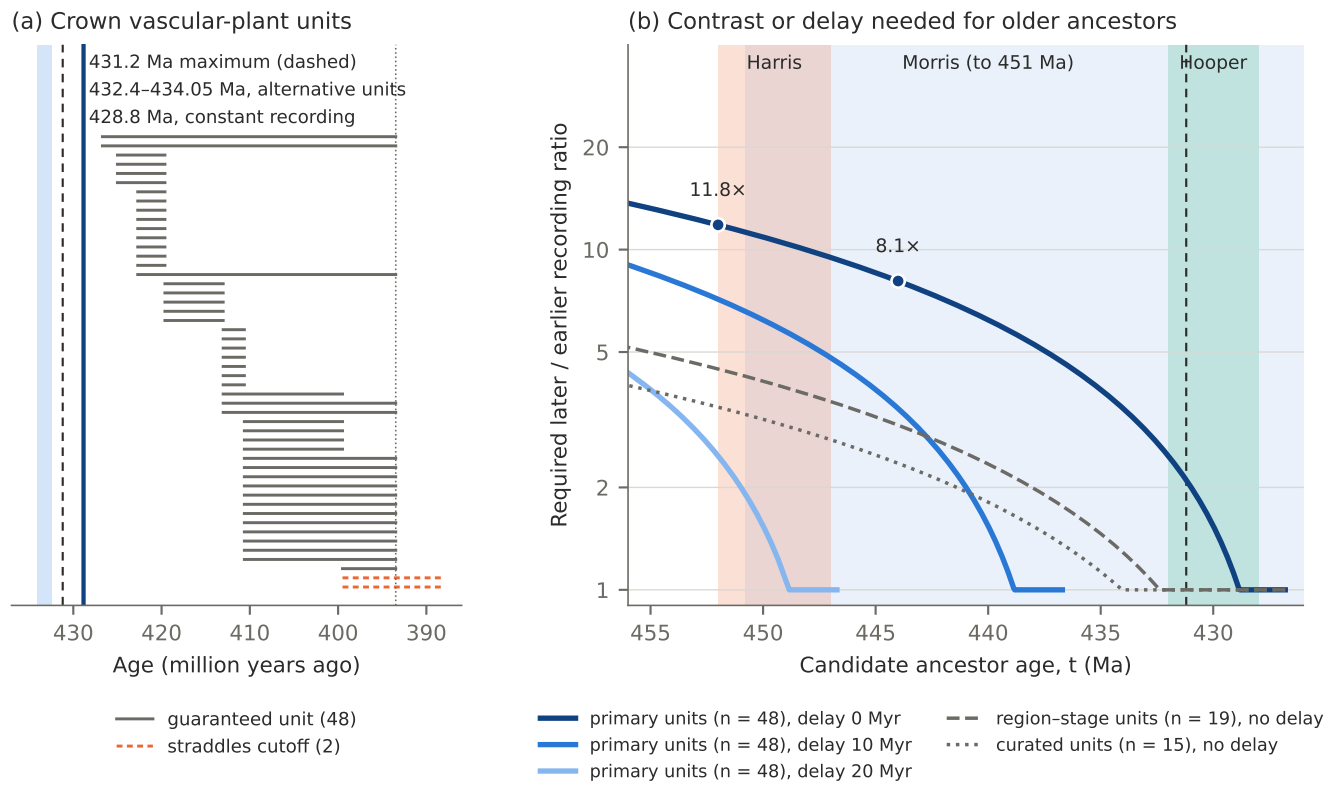
(a) Crown vascular-plant units
431.2 Ma maximum (dashed)
432.4–434.05 Ma, alternative units
428.8 Ma, constant recording
430
420
410
400
390
Age (million years ago)
guaranteed unit (48)
straddles cutoff (2)
(b) Contrast or delay needed for older ancestors
Harris
Morris (to 451 Ma)
Hooper
Required later / earlier recording ratio
20
10
5
2
1
11.8×
8.1×
455
450
445
440
435
430
Candidate ancestor age, t (Ma)
primary units (n = 48), delay 0 Myr
primary units (n = 48), delay 10 Myr
primary units (n = 48), delay 20 Myr
region–stage units (n = 19), no delay
curated units (n = 15), no delay